Aaron Sierra

Waco, TX

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CAREER PROFILE

Highly motivated, detail-oriented, and analytical computer science professional with a strong cybersecurity mindset and a passion for solving complex problems and learning new skills. Track record for developing innovative software solutions, demonstrated ownership of tasks, and collaborating with cross-functional teams. Proven ability to develop and test code for new applications and features with a strong commitment to delivering exceptional results and driving business success.

Programming Languages: Java, gradle, Bash, Python, C++, C, C#, Rust, Lua, .NET, Powershell, x86 Assembly, PHP
Libraries & Frameworks: .NET MAUI, React, Spring Boot, Bulma, Tailwind, Swing, Java FX, flutter, Django, Flask

EDUCATION

BAYLOR UNIVERSITY- Waco, TX **May 2025**
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | Concentration in Cybersecurity

EXPERIENCE

L3Harris | Fortune 209 – Waco, TX **June 2025 – Present**
Junior Software Engineer

- Replaced vulnerable Openfire servers with *Prosody* (*XMPP server)* on CentOS 7.9 & RHEL 8.10, integrating LDAP SSO and eliminating 100+ known CVEs in the internal messaging platform.
- Refactored a multi-module *Java/Gradle* codebase w/ 28+ builds to run consistently across multiple operating systems, standardizing build scripts and enabling flexible, cross-platform development for the engineering team.
- Designed and deployed the team's first centralized *PowerDNS* infrastructure on Ubuntu with 1 primary and 2 secondary servers, replacing /etc/hosts files and eliminating the single point of failure in internal name resolution.
- Owned end-to-end development of a Windows desktop client to simplify access to *JFrog Artifactory* on an air-gapped network, using *Python* (PyQt, threads, PySignals), SQLite, and *Artifactory REST APIs*; designed with UML and developed via a *Docker Compose*–based Artifactory instance, and delivered an exe containing a GUI with robust error handling and progress-tracked uploads/downloads that replaced the prior complex workflow.

Baylor University – Waco, TX **Aug 2024 – May 2025**
Undergraduate Cybersecurity Research Assistant

- Built and hosted a dynamic CTF competition at the Baylor BRIC to promote cybersecurity awareness month using HTML, CSS, Flask, SQLite, to create custom steganography and SQL injection challenges with rotating keys, creating automatically changing flags that increased replay-ability and reduced answer sharing among participants.

General Motors | Fortune 25 – Austin**,** TX **May 2024 – Aug 2024**
Software Engineer Intern

- Led team Sandilla as *Lead Software Engineer* on the Operating Systems Engineering (OSE) team, using Figma, Excalidraw, C#, and GitHub to plan and deliver 3 internal projects from concept to demo, executing a 25+ story-point POA&M and finishing 3 weeks ahead of deadline, with results presented to CEO Mary Barra.
- Refactored and enhanced 3 *C#* tools—a vacation scheduler, a coworker search app using the Microsoft Graph API for Teams contact, and a lunch scheduler enforcing a minimum of 2 staff per shift—improving schedule coverage and internal discoverability while securely managing API keys with HashiCorp.

Baylor University – Waco, TX **Jan 2022 – Aug 2022**
Cybersecurity Student Worker

- Designed and maintained weekly enterprise-style homelabs for the Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition, provisioning 12+ Linux/Windows VMs with Active Directory/LDAP containing 100+ users, relational databases (PostgreSQL, MariaDB, MySQL, SQL Server) with 500+ records, and web/infra services (nginx, Apache Tomcat, Caddy, FTP, SMTP, DNS) to simulate production environments and strengthen team competition readiness.
- Administered a multi-tenant Proxmox cluster for 25+ users and 100+ virtual machines, standardizing VM templates and clustering while migrating storage from RAID 1 to a 4-disk RAID 10 array to improve lab performance and fault tolerance

ADDITIONAL

- CompTIA Security+ Certified
- Bilingual: Native Spanish Speaker